



BACH HOUSE, EISENACH

The half-timbered house in Eisenach, once mistakenly thought to be Bach's birthplace, now serves as a museum to his life and work. It contains several of the instruments he owned and played.

Disgruntled employee

Bach finished his education at the age of 17 and set out to earn a living. After a spell in a minor post at the court of the duke of Weimar, in 1703 he became church organist, first at Arnstadt, then Mühlhausen, both towns in Thuringia. However, with his exuberant talents harnessed to mundane work, he proved to be a troublesome employee. The church authorities in Arnstadt were annoyed that he spent a long leave of absence in distant Lübeck, where he had traveled to hear performances by Dieterich